



TWELVE-MONTH PROGRESS REPORT

Legislation and regulation: progress report, 2025-08-01 to 2026-08-25

Edition of 2026-08-25 · compiled from the Data Landscapers source base

56 places. Every table below is carried verbatim from that place's own progress report; nothing is written here.

Movement values. *Advanced* — a system entered service, a stage was completed or an instrument was made. *Stalled* — a stated target passed without delivery. *Regressed* — an instrument was withdrawn or neutralised, or a measured position worsened. *Closed* — the programme ended. *No change* — the position at both ends is the same. *Baseline not held* — the base carries no position at the start of the period, so no movement can be stated. A value may carry a qualifying clause after a comma, as in *Advanced, slipped*.

The place reports do not share one window; the period above is the range they span.

Algeria

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-24	MOVEMENT
Domestic online-platform regulation (local presence, takedown, data residency)	Did not exist	Under examination; bill text not held and adoption not established	ADVANCED
National information-verification ("fact-checking") system	Did not exist	Draft examined; no regulator, legal basis or oversight mechanism named	ADVANCED
Presidential Decree 25-320 — national public-data governance framework	Did not exist	20 articles in force; art. 19 classification and cataloguing not shown to have commenced	ADVANCED
Law 18-05 on electronic commerce	BASELINE NOT HELD	In force; the great majority of online selling runs through social-media pages outside its obligations, with cash on delivery dominant (2026-08)	Baseline not held

Angola

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-24	MOVEMENT
Artificial intelligence bill	Did not exist	An 86-article draft in nine chapters out for public consultation, with a single critical-AI category carrying registration, security-risk assessment and emergency-response duties rather than a tiered risk pyramid, extraterritorial reach over activity abroad affecting Angolan interests, a right to explanation and to refuse AI-based decisions, criminal and strict civil liability, and no repeal of existing legislation; no tabling, committee stage or vote on record	ADVANCED

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-24	MOVEMENT
Cybersecurity bill	No cybersecurity law in force, and nothing held on a bill	Adopted by the National Assembly on 2026-08-12 by 104 votes to 56, on a presidential initiative, with the MPLA for and UNITA against and no abstentions; graduated administrative fines set as multiples of the national minimum wage, from 7 to 70 for individuals on minor infractions up to 500 for individuals and 4,000 for legal persons on the most serious ones; no promulgation, gazette number or entry into force on file. It requires telecommunications operators to transmit any communication whose content is criminal or prejudicial to state security, which UNITA and part of civil society object to as leaving unclear which content qualifies and on what terms subscribers' personal data reaches the authorities, a year before the presidential election	ADVANCED
Digital government bill	No framework law; sector rules dispersed since 1997	In public consultation, framed expressly around ending legislative dispersion and keeping the digital law and the data-protection law in step	ADVANCED
Electronic signature and certification regime	A public-key and time-stamp infrastructure announced by the ministry with no legislation, date or location	Authorisation granted to the President, valid 90 days after publication of the enabling law; the substantive text will be an executive instrument defining an accrediting authority, a root certification entity and the evidential weight of a signature	ADVANCED
False information law (Lei n.º 6/26)	Did not exist	A false-information regime binding telecom operators, digital platforms and application providers, reaching content aimed at the domestic public from outside the country, and banning inauthentic accounts and artificial disinformation networks	ADVANCED
National cybersecurity centre	Did not exist	A public institute with legal personality and administrative and financial autonomy, carrying regulatory, supervisory, inspection and sanctioning powers, an internal emergency response team and a round-the-clock operations department, retaining 30% of the fines it levies. On 2026-08-10 the telecommunications minister said the centre would be launched during 2026, to monitor digital threats, defend critical infrastructure and coordinate incident response	ADVANCED
Online falsehoods law	Did not exist	In force since 4 August 2026, gazetted as Lei n. 6/26 in Diário da República I Serie n. 146 after the Assembleia Nacional passed it 105-72 in May with only UNITA opposed; fines of 200-400 minimum wages, one to three years for simple publication, three to eight where it incites hatred or damages reputation, and up to ten in the aggravated case	ADVANCED
Startups law	Did not exist	Passed, with a legal definition of a startup at an annual revenue ceiling of about US\$3.5m and no minimum threshold, admitting pre-revenue ventures	ADVANCED

Benin

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-23	MOVEMENT
Extension of the biometric register to foreigners and Afro-descendants	Did not exist	Residents file with distinct foreigner and Afro-descendant identifiers	ADVANCED
Tax measures pushing merchants onto digital rails	In force (2025-01)	Levy plus the 2026 rectifying finance law's digital taxes	ADVANCED
Décret 2020-209 instituting the exchange	In force (2020-03-18)	In force; the signed decree now on file	NO CHANGE

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-23	MOVEMENT
Identity-linked SIM registration	In force (2025-04)	In force	NO CHANGE

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-23	MOVEMENT
Data-localisation law	Did not exist	Committed only; no draft, scope or timetable on file	ADVANCED

Botswana

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-24	MOVEMENT
Cybersecurity Act 2025	Not enacted; a Bill only (2025-08)	Made and gazetted, not in force at 2026-08-06, the stated April 2026 commencement having passed	ADVANCED, THE STATED APRIL 2026 COMMENCEMENT NOT ON RECORD
Digital Services Act	Passed 2024, not in force; a standalone services agency publicly contested (2025-08-18)	In force; the compliance clock runs to November 2027	ADVANCED
Electronic Payment Services (Amendment) Regulations 2026	Did not exist	In operation; scope extended to money or value transfer services, fit-and-proper reaching beneficial owners and 10% shareholders, unlicensed operation punishable by P1,000,000 and five years	ADVANCED
National Cybersecurity Authority	Did not exist (2025-08)	Created in law with a board, chief executive, a licensing power over cybersecurity providers, a power to approve software before market placement and a critical-infrastructure mandate; not established, and no organisation or vote in the FY2026/27 estimates	ADVANCED
Remote Service VAT Act	Announced, not in effect; the tax system described as built for tangible goods (2026-03-23)	In effect, with a stated collection target of about P450m a year	ADVANCED
Virtual Asset Act 2022 and provider licensing	Act in force, crypto not legal tender (2025-07)	Act in force; the regional assessor still records provider-oversight shortcomings (2026-02)	NO CHANGE

Burkina Faso

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-24	MOVEMENT
Fast-track procurement decree	A fast-track procurement route with loose conditions of recourse	Recourse restricted to national sovereignty, strategic character, grave threat to public order, security or service continuity, and humanitarian consequences of insecurity	ADVANCED
Headquarters-localisation decree	Did not exist	Firms above a revenue threshold must build headquarters in-country, with building standards set by revenue band	ADVANCED
Information-systems security law	In force since July 2024, with the auditor-accreditation duty asserted without machinery	Now carrying a decree identifying, classifying and setting obligations for critical-infrastructure bodies, plus a decree fixing periodic audits and auditor accreditation	ADVANCED
Whistleblower protection law	Carried by the justice minister, in preparation	No held source records adoption or any further step in the eighteen months since	NO CHANGE

Burundi

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-23	MOVEMENT
Access to information bill	Did not exist	Scheduled for examination; no text, tabling number, sponsoring ministry or timetable published	ADVANCED
Anti-money-laundering and counter-terrorist-financing regime	Baseline not held	Five circulars in force	BASELINE NOT HELD

Cameroon

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-24	MOVEMENT
Telecoms regulator public-establishment category	The regulator in the third category of public establishments	Reclassified from the third to the second category of public establishments by a finance ministry order, set on the regulator average realised budget across the 2022, 2023 and 2024 financial years	ADVANCED
Loi n. 2010/012 on cybercrime and cybersecurity	In force and invoked to justify network restrictions	In force and invoked to justify network restrictions; civil-society reform recommendations are pending and none is adopted on record	NO CHANGE

Cape Verde

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-23	MOVEMENT
Diploma on interoperability standards for public-administration systems	Announced for drafting in 2024 under the state-modernisation strategy; no adoption on record	Unchanged; no evidence the diploma was adopted, two years past its stated year, while interoperability is asserted as a working property of the government portal and the company registry	STALLED
Diploma regulating data governance in the public administration	Announced for drafting in 2024; no adoption on record	Unchanged; no evidence of adoption at 2026-08-06. A companion diploma on documentary classification, announced in the same statement, is likewise unadopted	STALLED
Legal frameworks for digital services, e-commerce and digital banking	Did not exist	Named among the declared reach of the National 5G Strategy approved on 2026-02-20, alongside a regulatory and business framework to support investment; no bill, draft or diploma is held	ADVANCED
Satellite communications regulatory framework (ARME)	Did not exist	Consultation covers licensing, radio-spectrum use, frequency coordination, user protection, network security and emergency communications for satellite operators; a direct regulatory response to Starlink's December 2024 launch in the archipelago; no draft text or adoption date is published	ADVANCED
General authorisation regime for electronic communications	Five operators authorised after ARME granted two new general authorisations in 2024; Starlink began activity in January 2025	Unchanged; no further authorisation or licensing change is recorded	NO CHANGE

Central African Republic

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-23	MOVEMENT
Public procurement code	The 2008 law governing, seventeen years in force and criticised in the explanatory memorandum for transparency, competition and control gaps	A new code with a FCFA 10,000,000 publicity threshold, a 5% preference margin for national and regional firms, a FCFA 2,500,000,000 small-business participation threshold and an eight-working-day formal notice	ADVANCED
Cybersecurity and cybercrime law	In force from early 2024, carrying six to ten year sentences and fines of FCFA 5m to 10m	Unchanged in text; named by a commentator in July 2026 as the instrument now used against online content	NO CHANGE

Chad

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-24	MOVEMENT
Code du numerique	No record at the window's opening; the code's development is dated from December 2025	No adopted text, number, promulgation date or gazette reference	STALLED
Committee to overhaul the digital, electronic communications and postal legal framework	Did not exist	Inaugurated with a forty-five-day deadline, and no draft, report or text on record	ADVANCED, THEN NO OUTPUT ON RECORD
Loi n 013/PR/2014 on electronic communications and postal regulation, as amended	In force unamended	In force with article 18 amended; the amending ordinance's text is not held, so the article's current wording cannot be stated	ADVANCED

Comoros

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-23	MOVEMENT
Code numerique	Not adopted, the 2024 target already missed	Not adopted	STALLED
Cybercrime provisions of the penal code	In force, covering technology-specific offences, online intellectual-property infringement, illicit conduct on electronic communications networks and online service-provider liability	Unchanged; no prosecution, caseload or enforcement figure is on file at either end	NO CHANGE
Cybersecurity law	Drafted and not enacted	Unchanged; the base carries no position dated after 2021-03-04	NO CHANGE
E-commerce law	Not drafted	Unchanged	NO CHANGE
Electronic-signature instrument	Did not exist	Did not exist	NO CHANGE

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-23	MOVEMENT
Loi n 14-031/AU on electronic communications, as amended	In force as amended; the regulator is funded by a statutory levy of 2 per cent of prior-year pre-tax turnover for licence holders, 1 per cent for authorisations and 0.5 per cent for declarations, plus a tenth of licence fees and two-fifths of pecuniary sanctions	Unchanged	NO CHANGE
Revised public procurement code for dematerialised procurement	Drafted and not enacted	Unchanged, with no procurement platform on record	NO CHANGE

Congo

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-23	MOVEMENT
Certified electronic invoicing decree	A voluntary pilot group, with electronic invoicing described by external staff as a component of the tax platform whose implementation was incomplete	Mandatory for every economic agent except the state, local authorities on public-service missions and diplomatic bodies, with terminals, software and enterprise modules homologated jointly by the tax directorate and the security agency	ADVANCED
Electronic-invoicing implementing orders	Did not exist	A four-stage homologation with a 30-day decision deadline, mandatory cryptographic certification, a penetration test under twelve months old, a sworn no-backdoor attestation, ten-year invoice retention and real-time tax-directorate data access	ADVANCED
Public-revenue payment order	Did not exist	All public revenue payable exclusively through one national platform, defined in the text as a national and sovereign payments switch; payment outside it is void and non-discharging, and administrations must suppress every parallel circuit	ADVANCED
Tax on newly imported SIM-capable terminals	Did not exist	Levied on importers of newly imported phones and tablets, paid by bank transfer with mobile-money channels announced, and earmarked for connectivity, digital services and infrastructure	ADVANCED

Cote d'Ivoire

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-24	MOVEMENT
National cyber-security agency	Agency launched and consolidating the cybercrime unit, the national computer emergency team and the alert line	Operating agency running a national security operations centre, a public-administration security-officer network, the national public key infrastructure and auditor certification against the state security reference framework	ADVANCED
Procedure for handling consumer complaints on electronic communications	Not held	Validated at a two-day workshop with operators, internet service providers and consumer associations and now going to the regulator's regulatory council for adoption, implementing the 2024 electronic communications law	ADVANCED
Regulatory Council of the telecoms authority	Outgoing council, whose mandate took more than a thousand sector decisions	New six-year council installed, with a roadmap of priorities handed to the minister	ADVANCED

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-24	MOVEMENT
Loi n 2013-546 on electronic transactions	In force with article 50 repealed	In force; its 2014 and 2016 implementing decrees on cryptology, electronic signature and digital archiving are the stated legal basis of the national public key infrastructure	NO CHANGE
Ordonnance n 2024-950 transferring the cyber mandate	Ratified, moving network security, audit, certification and electronic-certificate issuance from the telecoms regulator to the cyber agency	Unchanged in law; the transferred certificate mandate is now exercised through the national public key infrastructure	NO CHANGE
Loi n 2024-352 on electronic communications	BASELINE NOT HELD	In force, with 2025 operator compliance action plans evaluated, licence terms under revision and a common conformity framework being defined	<i>Baseline not held</i>

Djibouti

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-21	MOVEMENT
Startup Act (Loi n 179/AN/25)	Did not exist	In force from promulgation; every operative detail deferred to implementing decrees (2025-12)	ADVANCED
Digital Code (eight volumes, about 800 articles)	Adopted 30 June 2025	In force; no implementing decree held	NO CHANGE

DR Congo

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-23	MOVEMENT
Bill on the identification of natural persons	Did not exist	Tabled; it would set one legal frame for identification data and its collection, processing, retention and protection, impose security and interoperability requirements and connect civil-registry, migration and health databases; no committee report or plenary date is held	ADVANCED
Code du numérique	The framework law in force, its third book governing personal data, with no data-protection authority operational	The same law in force and now being enforced on the state's own initiative: the attorney general at the Court of Cassation instructed judicial police officers to open Digital Code cases proprio motu and forward them for summary hearing, and the audiovisual regulator's president is contemplating closing TikTok outright after the platform did not act on a request to block more than 2,000 accounts	ADVANCED
Interministerial order on digital-sector duties, taxes and fees	Did not exist	A two-tier dollar schedule keyed to whether a provider is judged dominant: cloud services US\$5,000 local and US\$15,000 foreign in the first tier against US\$2,500 and US\$10,000 in the second; data-centre declaration from US\$25,000 to US\$100,000 by tier; one startup line at US\$100. In force on signature 2026-07-20 under its article 5; a surseance announced by the finance ministry on 1 August 2026 and denied on 6 August 2026, neither position resting on a published government text; ministry's 8 August statement confirms registered 'entreprenant' start-ups are now fully exempt (not merely the US\$100 line reported earlier), still with no gazetted order or amending text published	ADVANCED
Satellite internet service-provider licence	Licensed since May 2025	Still licensed; the licence conditions, spectrum awards and any enforcement outcome are not established	NO CHANGE
Social register decree	A draft decree adopted in council	No promulgated decree number, signature date or publication held at 2026-08-06	NO CHANGE

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-23	MOVEMENT
Joint subcontracting enforcement by two regulators	BASELINE NOT HELD	A harmonised reading of the legal texts, joint inspection teams and enforcement of local-content subcontracting rules on large operators, with scope stated beyond telecoms to digital services and electronic commerce	<i>Baseline not held</i>

Egypt

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
Child national ID card proposal	Not on record	A member's proposal for a national identity card for children carrying a photograph from age five, requiring amendment of the Child Law, discussed at two workshops; recommendations included a unified national child-data platform, a full biometric identification system for children, and linkage between health, education and other government databases. No bill has been tabled	ADVANCED, A MEMBER'S PROPOSAL ONLY
Electronic service of judicial notices	Not on record	The postal service's digital postbox becomes the official platform for electronic delivery of judicial notices to individuals, companies and institutions, bound to the user's national identification number and carrying identity verification, electronic signatures and seals, encryption, delivery timestamps and correspondence tracking, so that a registered electronic message has the same legal validity as registered paper mail	ADVANCED
PDPL Executive Regulations, Decree 816 of 2025	Did not exist. The Alexandria Economic Court decided the Orange Egypt case in February 2025 on tort grounds precisely because the regulations were still pending, more than four years after the law passed	In force, establishing the approvals model, a separate licence for each cross-border transfer specifying destination, purpose, data categories and safeguards, extra approvals for electronic marketing and certain public-space surveillance, registered data-protection officers, and breach notification within 72 hours to the regulator and three business days to affected individuals	ADVANCED
Real property register conversion, Manshah section, Sohag	The title register was due to take effect for the Manshah city survey section on 2026-07-01 under a decision of 2000	Deferred by one year to 2027-07-01 by a justice ministry decision published in the Official Gazette, with settlement forms admitted for that section for two months from 2026-07-01 to complete the legal procedures	STALLED
Regulator unit monitoring AI-manipulated social-media content	Not on record	The ICT minister told Cabinet that a unit had been formed inside the telecommunications regulator which already detects and acts on AI-manipulated video and imagery, but that legislative amendment is needed to address the practices at root	ADVANCED
Social-media legislative review	Not on record; the base holds no proposal to amend the social-media statutes before 2026-07-29	A cabinet meeting chaired by the Prime Minister agreed on a review of the governing statutes, heavier financial penalties and public awareness campaigns; the ICT minister said a comparative study of other states' approaches is being prepared. No bill, text or timetable is stated	ADVANCED
Standalone digital-privacy statute proposal	No standalone digital-privacy bill on record	A member called on the government to bring forward a comprehensive digital-privacy bill criminalising recording and publication without consent, imposing takedown duties on platforms, raising penalties where fake accounts, defamation, extortion or vulnerable victims are involved, and widening investigators' powers to trace anonymous accounts	ADVANCED, A MEMBER'S DEMAND ONLY

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
Property ID Law	Approved by the House, having been introduced in August 2023; it mandates a unique digital ID for every property recording location, use, ownership, licensing, violations and transaction history, tied to a unified digital base map, and makes the property ID a prerequisite for registry or notary registration and for utility connections	Unchanged; no prime-ministerial decree naming the overseeing authority, no executive regulations and no commencement date are on record fifteen months later	NO CHANGE
Regulatory framework for foreign satellite operators	In force since 2024-07-09, the standing licensing instrument for any foreign satellite operator serving earth-station terminals in Egypt, granting categorical licences to operators supplying space capacity to licensed providers	Unchanged; no foreign low-earth-orbit operator has been licensed under it	NO CHANGE
Digital space bill	BASELINE NOT HELD	A 54-article, seven-chapter party draft that would require digital platforms to appoint a legal representative in the country and register influencers on a national platform, and would regulate the use of artificial intelligence, deepfakes, online extortion, gambling and child protection online; not tabled, and no text is published	<i>Baseline not held</i>
Financial Regulatory Authority technology sandbox	The base carries no position on the sandbox at 2025-08-01; the authority states that 2026-08 closes its first year	Live testing approved for three months, renewable, for two of the seven projects given preliminary approval in the first year: remote inspection and damage assessment in comprehensive motor insurance, and verification of foreign nationals' identities by reading electronic passports with NFC-equipped phones against international travel-document public-key standards, so that non-Egyptians can reach insurance, investment and other non-banking financial services; the authority reports 49 applications received, 7 given preliminary approval, 2 in live testing and regulatory guidance given to 45 entities	BASELINE NOT HELD

Equatorial Guinea

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-23	MOVEMENT
Press law revision	Did not exist	A parliamentary commission adopted 11 articles of the draft press law, leaving four articles outstanding — on the principles of the profession, the qualification required to practise, student interns, and professional secrecy	ADVANCED
Reform of the Ley de Prensa y Medios Audiovisuales (1997)	In force since 1997, with no provision for digital media or cable TV	Bill presented adding regulation of digital media and cable television for the first time, under committee review, with no adoption date or bill text published; a separate Copyright and Related Rights bill was presented alongside it, implementing Equatorial Guinea's 1997 Berne Convention accession and its 2015 Bangui Agreement obligations under OAPI	ADVANCED
Ley 7/2024 on social media and computer crime	In force	In force, with its provisions reported in rollout from July 2026	NO CHANGE

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-23	MOVEMENT
Reform of Ley 7/2005 General de Telecomunicaciones	Tender opened, scoped to cover AI, cybersecurity, critical infrastructure, satellite connectivity and data protection	No award, draft or revised timetable has been published in the fourteen months since	NO CHANGE

Eritrea

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-19	MOVEMENT
Bank of Eritrea cash-deposit legal notice	BASELINE NOT HELD	In force; no definition given of an 'excessive amount' held outside banks, and no enforcement mechanism specified; deposit deadline 31 Jul 2026	Baseline not held

Eswatini

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-23	MOVEMENT
Cybersecurity, critical infrastructure, e-commerce and AI legislation	Did not exist	Announced as forthcoming; no bill text or tabling date on file	ADVANCED
Online Media Publishing Guidelines 2026	Did not exist	Complete on the ministry's account, introducing publisher registration and rules on accuracy, privacy, child safeguarding and the responsible use of AI; text and commencement date not public	ADVANCED

Ethiopia

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
Telecommunications Licensing Directive 792/2021	In force (2021-07)	In force; unified operator licences awarded by competitive bidding and valid fifteen years	NO CHANGE

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
Berne Convention accession	Did not exist	Draft ratification proclamation submitted to the Council of Ministers; Ethiopia not yet a party	ADVANCED
Copyright Proclamation 410/2004 online-infringement amendment	Did not exist	Draft would add internet service provider duties, procedures for blocking infringing sites and a rights-holder take-down notice to the 2004 proclamation	ADVANCED
Critical Infrastructure Cybersecurity Proclamation No. 1426/2026	Did not exist	12 critical sectors designated, 18 core obligations on owners and operators, and a Critical Infrastructure Cybersecurity Fund; art.28 sets a one-year transition to commencement after gazettelement (about July 2027); the Council of Ministers and INSA hold regulation-making powers under arts.26-27	ADVANCED
Judicial review of licence revocation without court order	Did not exist	December 2025 decree struck down; revocation without a court order held unconstitutional	ADVANCED
Prohibition of virtual assets	Did not exist	The whole category prohibited absent express authorisation; no new rule, no enforcement mechanism	ADVANCED
Tax assessment of payment gateways	Did not exist	Three-year throughput restated from ETB 32bn to 143.9bn and taxed; corrected data refused	ADVANCED, AS AN ENFORCEMENT ACTION RATHER THAN AS POLICY

Gabon

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-24	MOVEMENT
Five implementing texts on the digitalisation of teaching	Did not exist	Five drafts validated - two decrees on digitalised learning and on blended-learning platforms, two orders on assessment and on the steering committee, and a decree creating the basic computing certificate	ADVANCED
Ordonnance n 0006/PR/2025 on digitalisation and electronic government	No comprehensive legal basis for electronic government	In force, mandating digitisation of administrative services, compulsory interconnection between administrations, and a national-preference clause in digital public procurement	ADVANCED
Ordonnance of 8 April 2026 on the regulation of digital platforms	Did not exist	In force, with provisions judged disproportionate by the association that recommends its revision	ADVANCED
Loi n 027/2023 on cybersecurity and cybercrime	In force, text not held	In force, text not held	NO CHANGE
Draft Code of Civil Procedure	Not held	A justice ministry commission submitted a draft running to more than 800 pages, rewriting the 1977 ordinance to introduce digitised and dematerialised procedural filings and secure digital tools, and to harmonise with the OHADA uniform acts; professional consultation and parliamentary debate are still ahead	BASELINE NOT HELD
Legal framework for the national digital identity system	No position held	Two texts named - a law on the personal identification number and a law on the national civil registry centre - with no adoption, promulgation or gazette date for either	BASELINE NOT HELD
Social-media regulation bill	No position held	Reported to exist and to await promulgation, with no title, number or adoption date given	BASELINE NOT HELD

Gambia

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-24	MOVEMENT
Broadcasting and Online Content Regulations, 2026	Did not exist	A draft instrument made by the minister in charge of broadcasting content under section 226(1) of the Information and Communications Act (Cap. 74:03) in consultation with the regulator, issued for public consultation on 2 April 2026 as one of seven draft instruments released together – among them Journalists Registration Guidelines, 2026 and licensing, registration and authorisation guidelines. Its fourteen parts run from objectives and general obligations through a content complaints committee, licensing and professional standards, classification tiers, content monitoring, local-content promotion, coverage of public events, public service broadcasting, watershed and children's programming, complaints handling, and enforcement and sanctions; the child-protection provisions the information minister set out cover the identity of child victims, parental or guardian consent for interviews with children, and content that harms or exploits minors	ADVANCED
Communications Bill 2025	Not introduced; first reading followed on 19 November 2025 (2025-08)	Passed second reading and referred to committee, with the Press Union pressing for repeal of the restrictive media laws around it (2026-07)	ADVANCED
State Intelligence Service Bill	Did not exist	Draft validated, reported to require judicial warrants and oversight for intrusive measures and to give the Assembly review of the Service's budgets and operations; not tabled (2026-07)	ADVANCED

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-24	MOVEMENT
Access to Information Act	BASELINE NOT HELD	In force, but with most public institutions yet to appoint the information officers the Act requires and twenty-one-day requests going unanswered	<i>Baseline not held</i>

Ghana

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-24	MOVEMENT
Data Exchange Act	None published	Named by the ministry as a statute distinct from harmonisation, carrying interoperability and inter-agency sharing, with no draft or timetable	ADVANCED
Data Harmonisation Bill	Named as a forthcoming Act the new board must support, with no draft	Consulted on and still a bill, renamed an Act in the July 2026 AI plan, not laid before Parliament	ADVANCED
Electronic Transactions Bill 2025	The 2008 electronic transactions Act as the standing baseline, with no replacement on record	A draft that would mandate age verification for child-accessible services, ban targeted advertising to children and impose risk assessments and semi-annual transparency reports on very large platforms	ADVANCED
Right to Information Act 2019 (Act 989)	<i>Baseline not held</i>	In force and enforced: the Right to Information Commission fined 254 public bodies GHS 20,000 each for failing to file their mandatory 2025 annual reports, after reminders published in the Gazette; no collection figure, appeal outcome or compliance rate published	ADVANCED
SIM re-registration legislative instrument	<i>Baseline not held</i>	Still not laid on file, with the first-quarter 2026 start date passed and a later-in-2026 rollout restated in February	STALLED
Virtual Asset Service Providers Act 2025	No statute, with more than 3 million virtual-asset users and over 100 service providers recorded in a July 2025 registration exercise, and regulated institutions directed not to facilitate virtual-asset activity at all	In force on the regulator's account, risk-based and technology-neutral with capital adequacy, client-asset custody and anti-money-laundering duties, supervision split between the central bank and the securities regulator by activity, licensing attaching to the service rather than to holding, virtual assets excluded from deposit protection and from any statutory compensation fund and barred from invoicing, pricing and wages, transition arrangements for existing operators, and the licensing requirements still being built	ADVANCED
Electronic Communications Act 2008	In force as the licensing statute for electronic communications	Unchanged; the statute under which 5G licences and submarine-cable landings are granted, which establishes the universal-access fund and sources it from contributions stipulated in each licence rather than from any rate set in the Act	NO CHANGE
Innovation and Startup Bill	A draft startup law under development, with no text	Still forthcoming, now tied to a national financial-technology fund it would give a legal base and eligibility criteria, with no draft published and none laid	NO CHANGE
Digital banking framework	BASELINE NOT HELD	Framework and comprehensive draft guidelines complete, awaiting stakeholder consultation before implementation, with no date	<i>Baseline not held</i>
Digital Economy and Innovation Development Fund Bill	BASELINE NOT HELD	Under legislative review, converting the universal-access fund into a wider digital-infrastructure, innovation and skills fund; levy rate, governance structure and the fate of the rural-access earmark all unestablished	<i>Baseline not held</i>
Emerging Technologies Bill	BASELINE NOT HELD	A draft that would create an emerging-technologies agency for cross-functional compliance across artificial intelligence, blockchain, connected devices, cloud and quantum, with voluntary startup registration	<i>Baseline not held</i>
Identity agency Act amendment	BASELINE NOT HELD	Would place the identity agency permanently under the interior ministry and grant security agencies defined access to the biometric citizen database	<i>Baseline not held</i>

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-24	MOVEMENT
Information technology agency bill	BASELINE NOT HELD	A draft that would overhaul the 2008 law, license every technology business, certify professionals, regulate artificial intelligence and blockchain and levy 1% on services, and split the agency's regulatory and commercial arms	<i>Baseline not held</i>

Guinea

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-23	MOVEMENT
Digital Analysis and Regulation Platform (PARN)	Did not exist	Created by decree; not on record as operating	ADVANCED
Digital Compliance Fee (RCN) on foreign digital services	Did not exist	3% flat rate for twelve months, then 1.5-7% by service category; exemption below 250m GNF of annual taxable revenue	ADVANCED
Digital Sovereignty Fund (FSN)	Did not exist	Created by decree; no capitalisation, governance or first disbursement published	ADVANCED
Electronic signature implementing decree	Did not exist	A decree fixing the implementing rules for electronic signature under article 1003 of the Civil Code, giving an electronic signature the same probative force as a paper writing where it is authentic, unfalsifiable, non-reusable, unalterable and irrevocable, extending it to administrative, private-sector and person-to-person electronic acts and imposing duties on electronic-certification services	ADVANCED
ARPT supervision of electronic transactions and mobile money	In force (2025-08)	In force: the posts and telecommunications regulator regulates and supervises electronic transactions including mobile money, with network and information-system security oversight, data collection, administrative police powers and the power to levy charges on mobile-money and electronic-payment traffic (2026-08)	NO CHANGE
Conseil National de Paiement	Does not exist	Does not exist	NO CHANGE
Loi L/2016/035/AN on electronic transactions	In force (2025-08)	In force as the frame for electronic signature, digital archiving, certification of information systems, consumer information duties in online commerce and the related fraud and forgery offences (2026-08)	NO CHANGE
Payment systems law	No payments statute	No payments statute	NO CHANGE

Guinea-Bissau

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-23	MOVEMENT
Digital Integrity (Dissemination of False Information on the Internet) Law	Did not exist	Enacted 21 May 2026 (CNT unanimous passage, with amendments); publication/in-force date and enforcement mechanisms unconfirmed; first invoked by the Ministry of Communication on 21 Jul 2026 over a false TikTok-shutdown claim	ADVANCED
Electronic Communications Law (revised)	Did not exist - the 2010 Electronic Communications regime remained nominally in force	Council of Ministers approved a revised bill, with amendments; not yet confirmed passed by the CNT or in force	ADVANCED

Kenya

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
Access to Information (Amendment) Bill	Did not exist	Would criminalise sharing classified information through personal messaging or email, on four classification tiers	ADVANCED
AI Governance Act	Did not exist	Named in the draft policy as the statutory backstop, with no text, sponsor or date	ADVANCED
Computer Misuse and Cybercrimes Act 2018	In force with false-publication offences and a non-judicial website-shutdown power	Narrowed by litigation, with the false-publication sections and the shutdown power struck and a conservatory order blocking a national internet shutdown	REGRESSED
Copyright and Related Rights Bill 2026	Did not exist	Out for comment, creating a Copyright Authority and a disputes tribunal, and carrying the 2001 computer-generated-work authorship rule forward unchanged	ADVANCED
Kenya Information and Communications (Amendment) Bill 2025	Gazetted 2025-03-07 as National Assembly Bill No. 9 of 2025	Before Parliament, proposing mandatory consumption-based internet billing: the Bill brings internet service providers inside the statutory definition of a telecommunication operator and would require each to run a meter billing system that assigns every customer a unique meter number, monitors usage, converts it into readable detail, invoices on consumption and lets the user verify the invoice, with meter numbers and billing-system information reported to the regulator at least once each financial year. It fixes no price, caps no tariff, sets no penalty and carries no data-minimisation clause. A second operator told the National Assembly Committee on Communication, Information and Innovation on 2026-08-20 that metered billing would raise costs, undermine fixed and unlimited packages, expose enterprises to bill shock from automated traffic they did not initiate, and raise data-protection and surveillance concerns through continuous granular usage tracking. No committee report, amendment schedule or enactment date is published	ADVANCED
Kenya National Library Service Bill 2023	Published 2023-06-14 to repeal the Kenya National Library Service Act 1965, with no digital provision on record	At Senate committee hearing, with the ICT ministry asking that electronic legal deposit, a national digital knowledge repository, digital preservation of public records, AI-supported cataloguing and interoperability with government digital infrastructure be written into the Bill	ADVANCED
Sexual Offences Act amendment package	Did not exist	Pre-parliamentary proposals on sextortion, stalking, voyeurism and AI-generated or altered intimate imagery, with an institutional duty to report	ADVANCED
Technopolis Act	Did not exist	In force, giving innovation cities including Konza a standalone legal framework with a development authority and a disputes tribunal	ADVANCED
Technopolis Regulations	Did not exist	Not finalised, with no draft on file	ADVANCED
Virtual Asset Service Providers Act 2025	Did not exist	In force, with pre-existing operators given until 2026-11-04 to comply	ADVANCED
Virtual Asset Service Providers Regulations 2026	Did not exist	Gazetted as Legal Notice 134, with joint central bank and capital markets licensing across ten categories, capital by licence class from KES 300m for stablecoin issuance to nil for advisers, and a seizure and freezing framework; Binance, Luno, VALR, Yellow Card, Kotani Pay and Roqqu have said they intend to apply, and the regulators had not announced the application process as at 2026-08-07	ADVANCED

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
Cyber cafe customer registration and session logging rules	BASELINE NOT HELD	Operators must capture each customer's name and identity number, the terminal used and session times, and retain the records at least three years, on pain of fines of up to 0.2% of annual turnover with a minimum of about US\$3,860. The regulator clarified on 2026-08-13 that the conditions do not require operators to track customers' browsing history. The licence conditions were published by gazette notice on 2026-08-07 and take effect on 2026-09-07	<i>Baseline not held</i>
ICT Authority Bill	BASELINE NOT HELD	On the forward legislative list with no text, sponsor or stage on file	<i>Baseline not held</i>
Kenya Intellectual Property Bill	BASELINE NOT HELD	Would merge three agencies into a new authority with an intellectual-property tribunal; the draft would merge the industrial property institute, the copyright board and the anti-counterfeit authority into one regulator, replace the 2001 and 2008 statutes, and set rules distinguishing AI-assisted from AI-generated inventions, with Parliament inviting public submissions	<i>Baseline not held</i>
Persons with Disabilities Act 2025	BASELINE NOT HELD	In force but setting no AI accessibility standards and no enforcement mechanism	<i>Baseline not held</i>
Repeal of the IEBC duty to livestream polling-station results	BASELINE NOT HELD	Two bills would remove the commission's statutory duty to create a mechanism for livestreaming results from the polling station: the Elections (Amendment) Bill 2024, passed by the Senate in December 2024 and awaiting the National Assembly, and the Election Laws (Amendment) Bill 2026, sponsored jointly by the Senate majority and minority leaders. Neither is enacted	<i>Baseline not held</i>

Lesotho

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-23	MOVEMENT
Cybercrime Bill	BASELINE NOT HELD	Split out of the Computer Crime and Cybersecurity Bill and awaiting National Assembly approval, on no published timetable	<i>Baseline not held</i>
Cybersecurity Bill	BASELINE NOT HELD	Split out of the Computer Crime and Cybersecurity Bill, intended to build the institutions protecting critical digital infrastructure, and awaiting National Assembly approval	<i>Baseline not held</i>

Liberia

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-23	MOVEMENT
LTA licensing and spectrum reform package	Licensing under the Telecommunications Act 2007 unchanged, with no satellite or device rules (2025-08)	Split of infrastructure and service licences, tower-sharing rules, first satellite regulations, an IMEI regime and repatriation of the .lr country domain announced; none published as instruments (2026-07)	ADVANCED
Mobile Money Regulations (Central Bank of Liberia)	In force (2025-08)	In force and unamended; the interoperable fee schedule of 2026 was approved under it (2026-08)	NO CHANGE
Satellite Communications Guidelines (LTA-GL-002-2026)	BASELINE NOT HELD	A licensing regime in force: five-year non-geostationary and ten-year geostationary landing rights, a US\$250,000 direct-to-device service-provider licence fee with 9% of direct-to-device sales and a 0.5% universal-access contribution, mandatory data-protection and cybersecurity compliance plans, and a twelve-month transition for existing operators	<i>Baseline not held</i>

Libya

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-23	MOVEMENT
Comprehensive cybersecurity law	None published	In drafting on the eastern legislative track	ADVANCED
E-payment mandate for state revenue collection	Did not exist	Treasuries and collecting agencies must accept electronic payment	ADVANCED
Law No. 22 of 2010 on telecommunications	In force; sole licensing power asserted by the GTI	In force; licensing jurisdiction contested between the GTI and the eastern ministry	NO CHANGE

Madagascar

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-23	MOVEMENT
Cybercrime bill overhauling the 2014 law	The 2014 law unamended	Bill adopted by the Council of Ministers and not enacted; it would define security incidents and critical infrastructure organisations, revise electronic evidence and connection-data retention, and require operator cooperation with justice. Revision was reported again on 2026-08-15 alongside signature of the United Nations Convention against Cybercrime and accession to the World AI Cooperation Organization, with Interpol findings that artificial-intelligence-enabled fraud is outpacing African states' response capacity given as the reason	ADVANCED
Dedicated social-media law	Did not exist	Announced; no draft held (2026-06)	ADVANCED
Electronic signature and interoperability decree	The 2015 electronic-signature law without an implementing decree	Draft decree validated and not adopted; a national interoperability committee provided for (2025-09)	ADVANCED
Order to block pornographic sites at internet service provider level	Did not exist	In force as a cabinet decision; no timetable, technical mechanism, named regulator or appeal route specified (2026-07)	ADVANCED

Malawi

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-24	MOVEMENT
AI Bill	Did not exist; no artificial-intelligence statute or bill appears in the base at 2025-08-01	Announced as the statutory backing for the National AI Strategy, to establish a regulatory framework promoting innovation while safeguarding citizen privacy and ensuring operational accountability; the ICT minister put the target for reaching parliament at before December 2026, with the strategy to ground the law, and restated the intention to legislate in August 2026. No draft text is stated and the strategy own text is not held	ADVANCED
Data Protection Act 2024	In force since 2024-06-03, with the regulator designated data protection authority; the statute exempted controllers and processors not of significant importance from compliance for 24 months from commencement, so most of the economy was outside the Act's obligations	In force, with the general exemption elapsed in early June 2026 so that all controllers and processors are within scope; subsidiary instruments to operate registration and enforcement were still in draft at 2026-08-06	ADVANCED, GRACE PERIOD ELAPSED

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-24	MOVEMENT
Financial Crimes (Amendment) Bill No. 19 of 2026	Did not exist; the base carries no bill or amendment on cheques or bearer negotiable instruments at 2025-08-01	Passed by Parliament removing all references to cheques and bearer negotiable instruments from the principal Act, as one of four bills passed together: amendments to the Financial Crimes, Payment Systems and Deposit Insurance Corporation Acts following the Bills of Exchange (Amendment) Bill that effects the cheque phase-out. Assent, gazette date and commencement are not published, and the safeguarding regulations the finance minister promised are not drafted	ADVANCED
Government Data Sharing Regulation	Did not exist; the national data-exchange platform operated without binding rules and ministries, departments and agencies shared citizen data by email, USB drive and paper	A proposed regulation would route all data requests through the national data centre, require encryption in transit and at rest, set a common digital standard for system-to-system exchange, and require binding data sharing agreements with usage limits and audit trails; it is not made, and no draft text is held	ADVANCED
Review of the National Registration Act	The base carries no statement on the Act's status or on any review of it	An acceleration-project consultative meeting has reviewed the National Registration Act and the marriage and family relations statute, with the registration bureau stating the aim is to support a modern and secure civil registration and identification system; no bill, draft or timetable is on record	BASELINE NOT HELD

Mali

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-24	MOVEMENT
Data-management law	None published	Recommended; nothing tabled	ADVANCED
Platform-content enforcement instruction	Did not exist	In force as an instruction, built on existing penal and cybercrime provisions with no new statute	ADVANCED
Startups law	None published	Recommended; nothing tabled	ADVANCED

Mauritania

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-23	MOVEMENT
Startup Act	Draft bill in public consultation, targeting 300 labelled start-ups and 3,000 jobs over five years	Enacted 2 January 2024; the promulgated text is not held, but the ministry's pre-enactment deck sets out a merit-based label with a preferential public-procurement margin (Article 13), a state-backed start-up fund and guarantee fund with investor tax incentives (Article 21), payroll-cost relief and a technology-innovation hub, and IP and customs relief	ADVANCED
Universal Service Access Fund governance	Governed by Decree 2020-152 of 19 November 2020	A replacement decree approved on grounds that the fund's object, its resource mobilisation and allocation, and its integration into the state budgetary system were all unclear; the new terms are not published	ADVANCED
ANETA state digital agency proposal	BASELINE NOT HELD	Proposed by UNDP (31 July 2021) as an EPA under the digital ministry with about 50 staff, EUR 220,000 to set up and EUR 1.4m a year to run, and a draft creation decree; a June 2023 open-data strategy proposes reviving that decree to name the same body national interoperability operator; no adoption, decree or launch is on record	Baseline not held

Mauritius

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-23	MOVEMENT
Data Protection Officer Regulations 2026	Did not exist	Promulgated, formalising designation, qualifications, independence and reporting duties for data protection officers across public and private sectors, with a six-month compliance window (2026-06)	ADVANCED
Economic and Financial Measures (Miscellaneous Provisions) Bill	Did not exist	119 pages amending 58 Acts and repealing one, with staged commencement from 1 September 2026 and several provisions deemed retrospective, carrying the fintech committee, the AI City Scheme, the central bank threat-sharing platform, the virtual-asset solicitation rule and the digital travel authorisation; introduced, not enacted (2026-07)	ADVANCED
Electronic Transactions Act amendments	Did not exist as a stated commitment	Referred to as modernising the digital-commerce framework and consumer protection; no text, timetable or introduction date published (2026-07)	ADVANCED
Ministerial notice on online-content sanctions	Did not exist	A ministry communiqué restating the criminal exposure of online speech and of page administrators who fail to moderate on notice	ADVANCED
Ministerial warning on prosecuting online speech	None published	A public communiqué from the ICT ministry warning that online speech can be prosecuted under the Cybersecurity and Cybercrime Act 2021, naming the fake-profile, cyberbullying and undesirable-content offences and defining undesirable content to include material that is deceptive or inaccurate	ADVANCED
Social-media identity verification mechanism	Did not exist	Consultations opened toward a verification mechanism against disinformation, impersonation, defamatory content, scams and child sexual abuse material, citing 2,300 online-harm cases from January to June 2026 and frauds up to Rs 500,000; no draft instrument published (2026-06)	ADVANCED
Virtual-asset solicitation rule	Did not exist	Unlicensed solicitation of investors in Mauritius would be prohibited by any medium, defined to reach targeted or algorithmic advertising, platforms, applications, social media, influencers, affiliates, referral codes, seminars and webinars, with any publicly accessible communication presumed to target Mauritius; introduced, not enacted (2026-07)	ADVANCED
Cybersecurity and Cybercrime Act 2021	In force since 2021-12-10	In force as Act No. 16 of 2021, gazetted as Legal Supplement 567 to Government Gazette No. 173 of 24 November 2021; it is the statute the ministry's own online-content warnings rest on, carrying the offences of misuse of a fake profile (s.16), cyberbullying (s.17) and failure to moderate undesirable content (s.23) with their penalty scales	NO CHANGE

Morocco

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-23	MOVEMENT
Digital health bill 52.26	Did not exist	A 50-article bill adopted and now publicly opposed by doctors; implementing decrees due within 12 months of publication and provider connection within 24 months of the technical decree; text not published	ADVANCED, CONTESTED
Digital X.O framework bill	Did not exist	With the general secretariat; three pillars — data governance, sectoral digital identity, and interoperability on traceable consent; no text, article count or tabling date on record	ADVANCED, NOTHING ON RECORD SINCE

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-23	MOVEMENT
Electoral organic bill 53.25	Did not exist	A new article carries two to five years' imprisonment and a fine of MAD 50,000-100,000, with artificial-intelligence tools enumerated as a means of commission on four offences; candidacy filing and proxy voting via a dedicated electronic platform upheld under articles 154/72; new article 51 bis (fabrication, not mere dissemination) punishes AI-enabled election disinformation with 2-5 years and MAD 50,000-100,000, upheld against a press-freedom challenge	ADVANCED
Organic laws 54.25 on political parties and 55.25 on electoral lists	Not held	54.25 constitutionally cleared alongside 53.25, promulgation dahir not yet held; 55.25 institutionalises internet-based electoral-roll registration (resident and expatriate) and bars AI tools and social platforms from publishing referendum poll results, committee-adopted across four sessions 12-27 November 2025	ADVANCED
Personal data protection law 09-08	In force, commission supervising (2025-08)	In force since 2009; a recast bill is now in the legislative circuit per the regulator's own account (no transmission date or text held), described by the regulator as clarification rather than replacement	ADVANCED
Private member's bill on regulating artificial intelligence	A 17-article private member's bill before the bureau (2025-08)	Same; described as still under parliamentary deliberation, with no committee report or adoption on record	NO CHANGE

Mozambique

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-24	MOVEMENT
Cyber Security Law (Law 13/2026)	Not on record at 2025-08-01; draft cyber bills approved by government 2025-09	Approved by the Assembly of the Republic 2026-04-29, promulgated 2026-06-10 and published 2026-07-01, in force 90 days after publication on 2026-09-29 with implementing regulations due within 180 days; creates a national incident response team seated in INTIC and, at articles 67 to 71, a Cyber Security Fund managed by the National Cyber Security Authority and financed by a flat 1% of licensed cybersecurity providers' prior-year gross revenue under article 70(c), with licensed information and communications technology providers also obliged to contribute at no stated rate under article 67(3); secondary accounts put the penalty ceiling at 160 minimum wages and implementation cost at about 167.26m meticaís	ADVANCED
Cyber Security Law implementing regulations	Did not exist	Provided for by Laws 13/2026 and 14/2026 and due within 180 days of their publication on 2026-07-01; none made at 2026-08-09	ADVANCED
Cybercrime Law (Law 14/2026)	Not on record at 2025-08-01; a draft cybercrime bill approved by government 2025-09	Published alongside Law 13/2026 in Boletim da Republica I Serie n.o 123 of 2026-07-01, in force 2026-09-29 with implementing regulations due within 180 days; strengthens prevention, investigation and punishment of offences committed in cyberspace, provides for preservation and collection of digital evidence and for international cooperation, and repeals articles 256, 289, 336, 337, 338 and 339 of the Penal Code, replacing them with its own offences	ADVANCED

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-24	MOVEMENT
Data centre and cloud computing regulations	Two drafts in public consultation to 2025-03-30, both dated 23 December 2024: registration required of any data-centre operator whether or not the facility is in Mozambique, a resident legal representative for providers established abroad, four data-centre resilience categories, cloud providers categorised by the classification of information they may process, financial-sector data confined to the two highest categories, classified information confined to private clouds on national territory, a single operator portal with tacit approval where the regulator does not decide in time, and a sanctioning regime with mandatory cybersecurity insurance (2025-03)	Published and in force; INTIC preparing to extend the licensing framework to data centres and cloud platforms	ADVANCED
Digital-operator licences issued	None issued (2025-04)	19 issued, about 170 companies under evaluation (2026-06)	ADVANCED
Electronic Transactions Law licensing regime	Licensing regulation for intermediary electronic service providers and digital platform operators in force, no licences issued (2025-04)	19 licences issued of about 170 registered companies under evaluation; the fee is one national minimum wage plus 1% of revenue annually from the next fiscal year	ADVANCED
Telecommunications Traffic Control Regulations (Decree 48/2025)	Approved by the Council of Ministers 2025-10-28 and published 2025-12-16; in force from 16 December 2025	The powers to suspend or block services, compel call and internet-protocol detail records, issue binding technical norms and intervene in operator networks without consent are void; the government stated on 2026-08-04 that it will seek the same end by another route, naming no bill, instrument or timetable	REGRESSED
Universal Access Service Fund Regulation (Decree 11/2025)	In force since 2025-05-16, replacing the regime under Decree 62/2017 of 9 November	In force: contributions payable in a single instalment by the last working day of June against audited accounts filed by 31 May; spending capped at 55% infrastructure expansion, 14% digital inclusion for vulnerable groups, 14% television broadcasting, 14% operating costs and 3% innovation; universal-access operators must charge 20% below the normal tariff; infrastructure built with fund money is state property with mandatory national roaming and contracts of ten years maximum; fines run to 114 minimum salaries, split 60% to the fund and 40% to the state budget. The regulator's 2024 annual report states the contribution as 1% of each licensed entity's gross revenue for the preceding financial year	NO CHANGE
Online Copyright Protection Act	Not held	In drafting by the ICT institute for introduction next year, its board chairman naming authorship of artificial-intelligence output and liability for artificial-intelligence training as open questions the country has no law on	BASELINE NOT HELD

Namibia

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-23	MOVEMENT
Corporate Laws Bill 2025	Did not exist	At Draft 3 and out for public comment: it consolidates and re-enacts the Companies Act with the business and intellectual property authority as registrar, and clause 114 would require every company, and every external company establishing a place of business in Namibia, to keep in Namibia a register of beneficial owners recording each owner's name, date of birth, identity-document number and residential, business, email and postal addresses; company process is routed through the Electronic Transactions Act	ADVANCED
Cybercrime Bill	No bill named on the record; enforcement relying on the electronic transactions statute, the communications statute and the penal code	Named by the minister as being finalised alongside the data protection bill; no draft published and no tabling date given	ADVANCED, MARGINAL
Data Protection Bill	A tabling announced for September 2025, about twelve years after drafting began	Not tabled and not enacted; no data-protection statute in force at 2026-08-06	STALLED
Data Protection Bill, latest published draft	The March 2022 revised draft, 59 pages and eight Parts, the last version published for comment	The March 2022 revised draft remains the last version published for comment, with the supervisory authority at its Part 2; the draft's stated objects are establishing a Data Protection Supervisory Authority with its own powers and duties, obligations on data controllers and processors, rights for data subjects, and codes of conduct; the 2020 version is held alongside it, and no later text and no tabling record has been published	NO CHANGE
Electronic Transactions Act 2019	In force; covers electronic signatures, consumer protection and contracts but not cross-border data flow, data localisation or personal data protection	Unchanged; still the interim instrument law enforcement relies on for cybercrime, with the communications statute and the penal code	NO CHANGE

Niger

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-23	MOVEMENT
Civil-status regime	The previous civil-status regime	Ordonnance n2026-21 of 2026-04-22 with its application decret in force	ADVANCED
Enforcement against unauthorised satellite resale	No enforcement action on file	Formal notice against Wifi Zones with a 3 October 2025 deadline, carrying three months to a year and fines to 60m FCFA	ADVANCED
Loi 2018-45 prior-authorisation regime for electronic communications	In force	In force and enforced	NO CHANGE

Nigeria

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
Cybercrimes (Amendment) Act 2024	In force (2024)	In force; lawyers argue it is misapplied against dissent	NO CHANGE

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
7.5% VAT on electronic banking fees	Did not exist	7.5% VAT on electronic banking fees	ADVANCED
CBN payments data-localisation directive	Did not exist	Binding from 2027-01-01; no power sequencing published	ADVANCED
DEON digital consumer-lending regulations	In force (2025-07)	In force and enforced, with the WASPAN appeal before the Court of Appeal and the existing framework held in place by ministerial direction	ADVANCED, NOW UNDER APPEAL
Market-concentration caps and operational ring-fencing	Did not exist	25% of issuing against 15% of acquiring, on monthly market-share returns	ADVANCED
National Digital Economy and E-Governance Bill	Did not exist	Would elevate NITDA to a super regulator; overlap flagged by stakeholders	ADVANCED
NIMC Act 2026	Did not exist	Replaces the 2007 Act; the NIN made the foundational credential	ADVANCED
Presidential Executive Order on Virtual Assets Coordination	Did not exist	A Virtual Asset Council and Office with its secretariat at the central bank	ADVANCED
Tax collected by the revenue service	Baseline not held	NGN 27.1 trillion (US\$19.93bn) between January and July 2026, an average NGN 127.83bn (US\$93.98m) a day - 95.76% of the whole of 2025's collection and two-thirds of the NGN 40.71 trillion 2026 target - which the revenue service credits to digitised tax systems, four 2025 reform laws and an executive order closing loopholes	ADVANCED
Virtual-asset tax framework	Did not exist	1.5% stamp duty withheld in the asset itself and remitted in the originating token, alongside value-added tax and withholding tax; peer-to-peer and over-the-counter traders warned on 2026-08-14 that the charge could push activity into unregulated channels, the rules having been signed 2026-07-31 and announced 2026-08-03	ADVANCED
Investments and Securities Act 2025 treatment of crypto	In force (2025-05)	Crypto inside the securities perimeter	NO CHANGE
Judicial communique on digital evidence and artificial intelligence	BASELINE NOT HELD	Fifty-four judicial officers called for stricter authentication standards for AI-generated evidence and a review of the digital-evidence, cybercrime and privacy statutes, named genuine evidence dismissed as AI-fabricated as an emerging problem, questioned whether clicking agreement constitutes meaningful consent, and asked for electronic case management, virtual hearings and privacy-protected judicial platforms	Baseline not held

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
FCCPC competition probe of platforms and AI firms	Did not exist	Competition law used against uncompensated AI training on Nigerian journalism	ADVANCED
Framework for Compensation of Consumers	Did not exist	Automatic airtime credit in listed local government areas, with the qualifying thresholds unpublished	ADVANCED
Internet-platform regulation	Rules in force	Enforcement paused pending a unified digital-economy policy framework	REGRESSED
NDPA amendment bill	Did not exist	Before the assembly	ADVANCED
Private enforcement of data-protection rights	Did not exist	₦15m general damages for marketing after consent was withdrawn	ADVANCED
Securities regulator virtual-asset rules	Did not exist	Draft out for comment with thresholds set	ADVANCED
Social-media local-presence bill	Before the assembly (2025-03)	Through a Senate committee public hearing and into public consultation, with organised support and organised opposition on the record	ADVANCED

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
FCCPC consumer-protection penalty against Meta	Imposed, under appeal (2025)	Under appeal	NO CHANGE
Nigeria Tax Act 2025 and Tax Administration Act 2025	In force (2025)	The statutory base for the virtual-asset tax circular	NO CHANGE
NIMC Act 2026 substantive provisions	Not held	On a law firm's reading of the Act: the identity commission becomes the root certification authority for a national public key infrastructure and the national biometric-data repository; use of the national identification number is made mandatory across passports, banking, telecommunications and land dealings, while the Act states that proof of identity is not proof of eligibility or of citizenship; and unauthorised database access carries penalties of at least NGN10m or five years for an individual and NGN20m for a body corporate	BASELINE NOT HELD

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
Risk-based AI regime in the digital-economy bill	Did not exist	High-risk systems would face annual impact assessments; the bill is not passed	ADVANCED

Rwanda

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-23	MOVEMENT
Draft law on virtual assets	Did not exist	The rationale approved in principle and referred to committee; not enacted, with no text and no gazette date	ADVANCED
Single digital identification law	In force, with nationwide enrolment not yet opened	Enrolment open and scaling, with banks, hospitals, telecoms operators and government institutions expected to use the new authentication from the sunset date and legacy cards becoming invalid	ADVANCED
Central bank regulatory sandbox	Operating, with no published cohort or admission data	Still operating and cited as a sequencing model, with no cohort list, admission count or graduation figure held	NO CHANGE

Sao Tome and Principe

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-23	MOVEMENT
National Framework for Interoperability (Law 1/2024)	<i>Baseline not held</i>	In force since 2024; underpins DEX, single citizen portal, trade single window	NO CHANGE
Personal Data Guarantee and Protection Law (Law 03/2016)	<i>Baseline not held</i>	In force since 2016; fines up to STN 500m for legal entities, criminal sanctions up to 1 year imprisonment for serious breaches	NO CHANGE
AGER regulatory framework revision (Regulatory Entities Law + Electronic Communications Law)	BASELINE NOT HELD	Bills submitted; passage not confirmed in sources held	<i>Baseline not held</i>
Aggregated Identification Document Law (identity law)	BASELINE NOT HELD	Under review/consultation; passage not confirmed	<i>Baseline not held</i>

Senegal

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
Critical information infrastructure bill	Did not exist	Debated in plenary, with deputies pressing government on the offshore hosting of citizens' personal data — one objecting that records as sensitive as blood groups are entrusted to foreign firms and that national identity cards are managed by foreigners, another warning of the risk a cyberattack would pose to continuity of care — and the telecommunications minister arguing that protecting the digital estate is a duty of the state rather than an option	ADVANCED
Critical-infrastructure protection legal framework	None held	Law n° 25/2026 on the protection of critical information infrastructure and digital security was adopted unanimously by the National Assembly on 2026-08-20, seven days after reaching its intercommission. On the ministry's account it grades obligations by risk - ordinary networks and systems on standard requirements, critical infrastructure on enhanced ones covering monitoring, data backup, encryption of sensitive information, business continuity and disaster recovery, and regular resilience testing - establishes a National Cybersecurity Authority, a national computer emergency response team, sectoral teams and cybersecurity operations services, mandates in-country storage of state-sensitive data, and folds in technology-neutral standards for the AI era and the child-online-protection plan PAPEL. No promulgation date, gazette reference or text is published	ADVANCED
Décret n. 2026-807 on classified defence procurement	Did not exist	In force; contracts and partnerships concerning critical information infrastructure are an enumerated ground for defence classification, gatekept by a presidency-chaired commission, with silence after fifteen days counting as refusal	ADVANCED
Startup Act and labelling process	The implementing decree adopted; labelling not yet running	The labelling process launched	ADVANCED
Bill on a media and social-network regulator	A draft unveiled, entering the legislative process	Unchanged in held material	NO CHANGE, NO SOURCE SINCE 2025-01-24

Seychelles

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-23	MOVEMENT
NISTI Act 2025 (National Institute of Science, Technology and Innovation)	Did not exist	Assented 22 Dec 2025; commences on a date the Minister appoints — no commencement date on record	ADVANCED
Access to Information Act 2018 (ATIA) reform	BASELINE NOT HELD	Whitepaper published, drafting targeted end-2025; no Bill text or introduction date on record	Baseline not held

Sierra Leone

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-23	MOVEMENT
Electronic Transactions Act 2019	In force since 5 December 2019 with no certification authorities, evidence procedures, dispute mechanisms or penalties established (2025-07)	A gap analysis, policy memorandum and implementation roadmap commissioned under the READY Salone project running to 2028; no adoption date for any of the three (2026-07)	ADVANCED

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-23	MOVEMENT
Public Financial Management Act 2026	Did not exist	A draft act taken to stakeholder consultation as a replacement for the 2016 law, presented as tightening accountability, resource mobilisation and enforcement, and carrying digital payment reforms	ADVANCED
Subscribers Regulations 2025 (SIM-NIN enforcement)	Did not exist; the 2020 Subscribers Identification and Registration Management Regulations were the instrument on file (2025-07)	Operators fined 25,000 new leones per unregistered or pre-activated SIM, with a staged disconnection ladder; the six-month transition clock is presented as running from the announcement, so the phase-out date is unestablished (2026-07)	ADVANCED
National Communications Authority Act 2022	In force, with enforcement powers addressed to licensees (2025-07)	In force and unamended; the analysis finds its powers bind licensees only, leaving foreign platforms outside the perimeter, and identifies s.194 as the route to close the gaps without new primary legislation (2026-07)	NO CHANGE

Somalia

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-24	MOVEMENT
Cybersecurity Law	Did not exist; a cybercrime bill of August 2025 was the only instrument on record (2025-08)	In force, assigning policy to the communications ministry, technical oversight to the regulator and obligations to critical-infrastructure operators, and creating the incident response team (2026-01)	ADVANCED

South Africa

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
Electronic Communications Amendment Bill	<i>Baseline not held</i>	Tabled by the Minister of Communications and Digital Technologies on 2026-04-20; it would empower the local-government minister to make a national standard by-law on rapid deployment of electronic communications networks, introduce a use-it-or-share-it principle for spectrum, regulate roaming and mobile virtual network operator services, improve the facilities-leasing framework, provide for wholesale pricing rules and strengthen competition regulation. The Bill was published with its explanatory summary and prior notice of introduction in Government Gazette No. 54548 of 20 April 2026, and introduced and referred to the Portfolio Committee on Communications and Digital Technologies on 22 April 2026. Written submissions were extended by one month on 2026-08-20, to 16:00 on 2026-09-21, superseding the 2026-08-21 deadline	ADVANCED

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
National Identification and Registration Bill	BASELINE NOT HELD	Still before Parliament	<i>Baseline not held</i>

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
Capital Flow Management Regulations and Crypto Asset Manual	Did not exist	Both in draft; manual comments to end-September 2026; the Treasury and the central bank published a draft crypto asset manual for cross-border activities for comment to 30 September 2026, setting authorisation and reporting rules for crypto asset service providers and defining cross-border crypto flows	ADVANCED
Copyright Amendment Bill	<i>Baseline not held</i>	Constitutional Court ruling 2026-06	ADVANCED

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
Draft Electoral Code of Conduct on Countering Disinformation	Did not exist	A draft code published by the Electoral Commission under section 88 of the Local Government: Municipal Electoral Act 27 of 2000 for the local government elections, out for written comment to 22 July 2026. It carries no commencement date and no standalone sanction: paragraph 14 makes a contravention a breach sanctionable under the Act	ADVANCED
End-user and Subscriber Service Charter Amendment Regulations	In consultation	Gazetted 2026-01-23; under review application	ADVANCED, LITIGATED
Operation Vulindlela reporting	80% of initiatives on track (2026-04)	"Uneven and slower than anticipated"	REGRESSED
POPIA enforcement notices	None held	Three notices, May–June 2026	ADVANCED
SADC real-time settlement	Rand only since 2013	Kwaza added 2026-07-27	ADVANCED
Breach notification rate	~284 per month (Apr–Nov 2025)	~263 per month (Q1 2026)	NO CHANGE
National Open Science Policy	BASELINE NOT HELD	Implemented (undated)	Baseline not held

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
Conduct of Financial Institutions Bill	BASELINE NOT HELD	In development (2026-01-30)	Baseline not held

South Sudan

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-24	MOVEMENT
Cyber Crimes and Computer Abuse Act 2026	Did not exist	In force; the full text was withheld from journalists at signing (2026-02)	ADVANCED
ICT Authority	Did not exist	Being established as a state entity under the ICT ministry while legislation is awaited (2026-08)	ADVANCED
South Sudan Official Gazette	Not operating; no law, decree or resolution published since 2011 (2025-08)	A technical committee ordered to operationalise the physical and electronic editions with encrypted digital verification, read-only public access on a redesigned presidential website, and clearance of the publication backlog since 2011; no maiden edition is on file (2026-08)	ADVANCED, NO EDITION PUBLISHED
National Payment System Bill, 2025	Not held	Validated at a five-day workshop opened on 10 August 2026 by the central bank and parliament, backed by the East African Community secretariat and the Bank of Uganda, covering mobile money, electronic money, payment switches and real-time gross settlement with licensing, consumer-protection and systemic-risk provisions; on 17 August the central bank governor called for faster progress toward passage	BASELINE NOT HELD

Sudan

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-23	MOVEMENT
Cybercrime law prosecutions for speech	No prosecution series held	A pharmacist sentenced to six years over a private phone conversation opposing the war, convicted under the 1991 criminal code and the cybercrime law after intelligence officers searched his phone, and a journalist detained on a cybercrime complaint filed by an intelligence officer and held without questioning	REGRESSED

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-23	MOVEMENT
Border-trade legal framework (state-level protocols)	BASELINE NOT HELD	Resolution passed to review and unify state-level agreements; no transition arrangement, timetable or affected-protocol list given	<i>Baseline not held</i>
Draft Digital Transformation Law of 2026	BASELINE NOT HELD	No text published. The justice ministry states it is preparing the instrument in coordination with the digital transformation and communications ministry, as the Digital Transformation Regulation Law of 2026	<i>Baseline not held</i>

Tanzania

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-24	MOVEMENT
Finance Act 2026 amendment to the Electronic Transactions Act	No ministerial power to prescribe which payments must be made electronically	The Minister for Finance may prescribe by Gazette order which payments must be made electronically — the power the mandatory electronic payments order of the same date was made under — and proof of electronic payment is required before a transfer of land, a building or a motor vehicle can be approved	ADVANCED
Tax identifier display for online traders	Did not exist	Businesses trading on social media platforms must display their tax registration number or tax compliance certificate on their profile pages, under a new sub-regulation 58(2) of the Tax Administration (General) Regulations, 2016, made under the Tax Administration Act	ADVANCED
Financial consumer protection amendment regulations	In force from 2025-05-23	Unchanged; providers must protect consumer financial and personal information in accordance with the data-protection Act	NO CHANGE
Review of more than 1,000 laws for technology investment	Not held	The government says it will review more than 1,000 laws, including the public-private partnership act, the companies act and financial legislation, to build a regulatory framework supporting artificial intelligence, digital commerce and technology investment under the 2050 development vision	BASELINE NOT HELD

Togo

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-23	MOVEMENT
Anti-money-laundering law of 2025	The 2018 statute in force, with no risk-based approach and no due diligence on virtual-asset service providers	The 2025 law adopted, replacing the 2018 statute with a risk-based approach, due diligence extended to virtual-asset service providers and strengthened beneficial-ownership identification	ADVANCED
Decret n 2023-040/PR on electronic-communications fees and royalties	In force as signed, with no satellite or satellite machine-to-machine spectrum royalty rates	Amended on 2026-07-30 to price spectrum use for satellite services and machine-to-machine traffic; the amending text was unpublished at 2026-07-31	ADVANCED
Rules on mobile commercial offers	Did not exist	New provisions governing the validity and billing conditions of mobile commercial offers and their promotional mechanisms	ADVANCED
Commercial-courts reform and Hague Apostille accession bills	Not held	Two bills adopted in first reading by the National Assembly, one reforming the commercial-courts law to complete electronic filing and online hearings and align with the OHADA uniform act, the other authorising accession to the Hague Apostille Convention	BASELINE NOT HELD

Tunisia

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-24	MOVEMENT
Compulsory e-invoicing (Article 53)	Legislated to take effect 1 January 2026 for all service providers regardless of invoice value or firm size (2025-08)	Under amendment: parliament's memo records that no unified national e-invoicing system yet exists and that mass e-invoicing raises serious personal- and professional-data protection issues, and the amendment mandates a 30-day joint ministerial report on readiness and data-protection compliance before a phased timeline (2026-02)	ADVANCED
Development Plan 2026-2030 (loi n 2026-16)	Did not exist as an adopted instrument	Promulgated as the binding reference for public policy to 2030 under articles 75 and 77 of the Constitution, adopted by the Assembly on 10 July and the Council of Regions on 17 July (2026-07)	ADVANCED
Organic Laws 22 and 23 of 2024 on biometric identity	In force; use was targeted for the first half of 2025 and unconfirmed (2025-08)	In force; nothing held confirms issuance has begun, and an amendment to prohibit a centralised biometric database held by the interior ministry was introduced the day before the vote and dismissed (2026-08)	NO CHANGE

Uganda

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-24	MOVEMENT
Computer Misuse Act ss.11, 23, 26-29	In force and the state's main tools for prosecuting online speech (2025-08)	Struck down, together with Penal Code ss.162-163 on criminal libel	REGRESSED
Digital lending platform regulation	Did not exist	The microfinance minister told a Kampala retreat that government is moving to close regulatory gaps around digital lending platforms, set against financial inclusion of 81 per cent (2023) from 70 per cent (2009) and an 85 per cent target for 2028 under the second national financial inclusion strategy	ADVANCED
Protection of Sovereignty Bill, 2026	Not on file (2025-08)	Before joint parliamentary committees in April 2026; described as recently enacted on 2026-08-02, with no assent date, gazette notice or text held	ADVANCED
Telecom-infrastructure vandalism enforcement	No convictions on file (2025-08)	A five-year sentence for mast vandalism in Kibaale, USh23.6m of damage, and a one-year sentence for a SIM-registration breach	ADVANCED
UCC enforcement against unlicensed public Wi-Fi	Did not exist (2025-08)	Nationwide campaign under way; unlicensed operators told to regularise or cease; no count of operators actioned	ADVANCED
UCC order suspending public internet	No shutdown order in force (2025-08)	Connectivity cut from 18:00 local (15:00 UTC) 2026-01-13 and restored 23:00 local (20:00 UTC) 2026-01-17 — 4 days 5 hours by measurement; UCC announced restoration from midnight 2026-01-18 with social media and OTT apps still blocked; full restoration announced 2026-01-26, 13 days after the order. The Uganda Law Society called it unlawful for want of a state of emergency; the directives were ordered tabled on 2026-03-10	ADVANCED

Zambia

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-24	MOVEMENT
Cyber Security Act No. 3 of 2025, statutory text	The statutory text was not held, so the Act's provisions rested on secondary characterisation	Held in full. Assented 8 April 2025, published in the Supplement to the Government Gazette 15 April 2025, commenced 12 May 2025 by Statutory Instrument 22 of 2025; 66 sections in seven Parts, repealing and replacing the Cyber Security and Cyber Crimes Act 2021. Part V (sections 21 to 40) is the interception regime and is gated on a judge of the High Court	ADVANCED
Postal and Courier Services Bill 2026	Did not exist. Cabinet approved the review of the Postal Services Act No. 22 of 2009 in principle at its 17th meeting in September 2025, after the window opened	Ten-province stakeholder consultations concluded 2026-07-22 and a public call for written submissions closed 2026-07-27; the Bill would repeal and replace the 2009 Act, strengthen universal service obligations, modernise licensing, reinforce regulatory oversight and extend services to underserved areas through the universal access fund. No draft text, gazette notice or parliamentary date is on file	ADVANCED
Mobile money levy	In force under a 2023 levy act	In force, with the rate doubled at some point in 2025; the industry levy table is stated as current to Q3 2025. No Zambian rate, base, statutory instrument, effective date or revenue outturn is held	NO CHANGE
ICT (Universal Access) Regulations, 2012	No position held on the statutory basis of Zambia's universal-access levy	Statutory Instrument No. 38 of 2012 sets the licensee contribution to the Universal Access and Service Fund at not exceeding 1.5% of gross annual turnover, capped at 50% of total collectable annual operating fees payable to the regulator, payable annually in advance; the Fund may also receive parliamentary appropriations, grants and donations. No amendment, repeal or updated rate is on record.	BASELINE NOT HELD
Startup Bill	Baseline not held	Named once, alongside the National AI Strategy, as an instrument through which the government would advance artificial intelligence; no text, sponsor, drafting stage, timetable or budget is held	BASELINE NOT HELD

Zimbabwe

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-23	MOVEMENT
Local-ownership rule for telecommunications operators and its repeal	Did not exist	A 75% citizen-ownership floor and a 25% foreign-ownership ceiling for every postal and telecommunications licence, with sworn beneficial-ownership affidavits, 90 days for existing licensees to file a regularisation plan and three years to comply; reported repealed in full by Statutory Instrument 111 of 2026	CLOSED, GAZETTED THEN REPEALED
Postal and Telecommunications (Amendment) Bill, 2025	Did not exist	Gazetted 2025-10-10 and not in force, commencement left to a date the President fixes by statutory instrument; before the Parliamentary Legal Committee at 2026-08-02 with the National Assembly adjourned to 2026-08-18; the replacement section 25 fences the minister's power to direct the regulator, requiring directions to be prospective, of general application and consistent with the Act	ADVANCED
Regulatory Notice 1 of 2026	Did not exist	A warning to unlicensed data controllers, with surveillance and biometric processors expressly in scope	ADVANCED
Regulatory Notice 2 of 2026	Did not exist	Issued; risk-based inspections from 2026-09-01, with the sector list and fee tiers known only through press	ADVANCED

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-23	MOVEMENT
Statutory Instrument 155 of 2024 on data-controller licensing	The licensing deadline lapsed with wide non-compliance; no enforcement step on record (2025-08)	Mandatory compliance inspections set for 2026-09-01; four fee tiers by data-subject count – US\$50 a year for 50-1,000 subjects, US\$300 plus a US\$30 application fee for 1,001-100,000, and US\$500-2,500 above that; a separate certified Data Protection Officer requirement costs US\$1,250 plus a US\$30 application fee, so a small organisation faces over US\$1,300 in first-year compliance cost; processing without a licence carries a Level 11 fine and up to seven years' imprisonment for the accountable chief executive	ADVANCED
Statutory instrument on e-hailing services	Did not exist	A statutory instrument being drafted to bring e-hailing services inside the public-transport regulatory framework, the transport minister telling Parliament that Cabinet had directed the ministry to act because the road transport statute carries no provision for the named platforms	ADVANCED
Third constitutional amendment on the voters' roll	The roll held by the electoral commission under the 2013 Constitution	Transfer to the registrar-general under way; no date, transition plan or safeguard stated	ADVANCED
Cyber and Data Protection Act	In force; the regulator designated as data protection authority	Unamended; administrative sanctions still not provided for (2026-05-14)	NO CHANGE

Southern Africa

BODY, INSTRUMENT OR SYSTEM	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-24	MOVEMENT
Digital platform governance toolkit (RIA/UNESCO)	Did not exist	Published with a five-part self-assessment checklist, eight legislative building blocks and a five-tier escalation ladder; no regulator adoption on record	ADVANCED
SADC Computer Crime and Cybercrime Model Law	In force as a model since November 2012, unrevised	Unchanged; no revision, successor or transposition record held	NO CHANGE
SADC Electronic Transactions and Electronic Commerce Model Law	In force as a model since November 2012, unrevised	Unchanged; no revision, successor or transposition record held	NO CHANGE

West Africa

BODY, INSTRUMENT OR SYSTEM	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-24	MOVEMENT
Cybercrime statutes in the Sahel states	BASELINE NOT HELD	A press-freedom organisation reports the cybercrime statutes of Burkina Faso, Mali, Niger and Guinea being used to prosecute journalists, and calls for the repeal of vague public-order and human-dignity provisions	<i>Baseline not held</i>

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